Water Service Quality Score (WSQS)

International Research Survey

43 core questions and three optional sensitivity questions, adapted from the original Stanford Water Service Survey.

Participant information and consent

Purpose. This study examines household experiences with water supply, including affordability, access, reliability, efficiency, acceptability, perceived quality, quantity and customer service.

Participation. Participation is voluntary. You may skip questions or stop at any time without penalty. The research survey includes household circumstances and service priorities.

Expected duration. [Provide a duration based on local pilot testing.]

Risks and benefits. [Explain the actual study-specific risks, safeguards and any benefits.]

Confidentiality and data use. [Explain what is collected, identifiability, data access, storage, retention and any de-identified data sharing.]

Withdrawal. [State when and how responses may be withdrawn, including limitations after anonymization or aggregation.]

Study team and ethics contact. Organization: _____ Principal investigator: _____ Study contact: _____ Independent ethics contact, if applicable: _____

Consent. [ ] I voluntarily agree to participate. [ ] I do not agree to participate.

The administering research team must complete and approve the study-specific consent information before distributing this questionnaire.

Water source

1. Q1.1. What is your household's primary source of water for domestic use (for example, drinking, cooking and cleaning)?

- □ Public or utility piped supply
- □ Groundwater (well or borehole)
- □ Surface water (river, lake or pond)
- □ Water delivered by tanker or truck
- □ Purchased packaged water (bottles or containers)
- □ Other water source

2. Q1.2. About what percentage of your household's total water use comes from each of the six source types in Q1.1?

- □ Public or utility supply: ____ %
- □ Groundwater: ____ %
- □ Surface water: ____ %
- □ Tanker or truck: ____ %
- □ Purchased packaged water: ____ %
- □ Other source: ____ %
- □ All six percentages must total 100%.

3. Q1.3. What is your household's main source of drinking water?

- □ Public or utility piped supply
- □ Groundwater (well or borehole)
- □ Surface water (river, lake or pond)
- □ Water delivered by tanker or truck
- □ Purchased packaged water (bottles or containers)
- □ Other water source

Affordability

4. Q2.2. How affordable is your household's drinking water, considering any costs of purchasing, treating or obtaining it?

- □ Very affordable
- □ Somewhat affordable
- □ Neutral
- □ Somewhat unaffordable
- □ Very unaffordable

5. Q2.3. Approximately how much does your household spend on drinking water in a typical week?

- □ Amount: _____ Local currency: _____
- □ Costs are not measured separately
- □ Do not know

6. Q2.5. How would you rate the value of the water service your household receives relative to what it costs?

- □ Excellent
- □ Good
- □ Average
- □ Poor
- □ Very poor

7. Q2.8. Does your household face financial difficulties purchasing additional water during supply interruptions?

- □ Yes, sometimes
- □ Yes, only seasonally
- □ Yes, often
- □ No
- □ Our household has not experienced interruptions that I am aware of

8. Q2.9. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much do water costs and affordability affect your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Access

9. Q3.1. How accessible is your primary drinking water supply (for example, ease of reaching a tap, well or water seller)?

- □ Very accessible
- □ Accessible most of the time
- □ Occasionally accessible
- □ Rarely accessible
- □ Not accessible

10. Q3.2. If your household must travel to collect water, approximately how long does the journey take?

- □ No travel required
- □ Less than 15 minutes
- □ 15–30 minutes
- □ 30–60 minutes
- □ More than one hour

11. Q3.3. Approximately how much time does your household spend each day obtaining drinking water?

- □ No time required
- □ Less than 15 minutes
- □ 15–30 minutes
- □ 30–60 minutes
- □ More than one hour

12. Q3.5. If your household uses public or utility-managed piped water, when is that water available?

- □ Available at any time
- □ Available at scheduled times
- □ Not available
- □ Our household does not use this kind of supply

13. Q3.6. If your household receives water on a schedule from a public or utility-managed network, how often is it supplied?

- □ Continuous, 24 hours a day
- □ A few hours each day at set times
- □ Every other day
- □ A few days each week
- □ Approximately every other week
- □ Not applicable: no relevant network service

14. Q3.9. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much access to water affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Reliability

15. Q4.1. How reliable is your primary water supply?

- □ Always reliable
- □ Mostly reliable
- □ Occasionally reliable
- □ Rarely reliable
- □ Not reliable

16. Q4.2. If your household receives piped water, how adequate is its water pressure?

- □ Always sufficient
- □ Mostly sufficient
- □ Occasionally low
- □ Frequently low
- □ Always low
- □ Not applicable: no piped supply

17. Q4.3. Does your water supplier communicate planned water-supply interruptions in advance?

- □ Always
- □ Most of the time
- □ Occasionally
- □ Rarely
- □ Never
- □ There is no communication channel
- □ Not applicable: no supplier or planned interruptions

18. Q4.4. Does your household have stored water or another backup in case its usual supply fails?

- □ Yes, enough backup water
- □ Yes, but limited backup water
- □ No backup water
- □ Our primary source is not affected by such failures

19. Q4.5. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much water-supply reliability affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Efficiency

20. Q5.1. How do you rate the efficiency of your primary water system? Efficiency means delivering sufficient water with minimal household effort, delay or energy use.

- □ Very efficient
- □ Efficient
- □ Neutral
- □ Inefficient
- □ Very inefficient

21. Q5.2. Does the amount or availability of your water supply vary between seasons?

- □ No
- □ Yes, only minor variations
- □ Yes, significant variations

22. Q5.3. How would you rate the maintenance of the water infrastructure serving your household?

- □ Well-maintained
- □ Somewhat maintained
- □ Poorly maintained
- □ Do not know how it is maintained

23. Q5.4. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much water-system efficiency affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Acceptability

24. Q6.1. Are you satisfied with your current primary water supply source?

- □ Completely satisfied
- □ Mostly satisfied
- □ Neutral
- □ Mostly dissatisfied
- □ Completely dissatisfied

25. Q6.2. How acceptable is the appearance of the water (including color and clarity)?

- □ Completely acceptable
- □ Somewhat acceptable
- □ Neutral
- □ Somewhat unacceptable
- □ Completely unacceptable

26. Q6.3. How acceptable is the taste of the water?

- □ Completely acceptable
- □ Somewhat acceptable
- □ Neutral
- □ Somewhat unacceptable
- □ Completely unacceptable

27. Q6.4. How acceptable is the smell or odor of the water?

- □ Completely acceptable
- □ Somewhat acceptable
- □ Neutral
- □ Somewhat unacceptable
- □ Completely unacceptable

28. Q6.6. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much water acceptability affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Quality

29. Q7.1. How would you rate the quality of water you receive, considering its condition and any contamination you know about?

- □ Excellent
- □ Good
- □ Neutral
- □ Poor
- □ Very poor

30. Q7.3. Is your water visibly clear and free from sediments or solid particles?

- □ Always clear
- □ Mostly clear
- □ Occasionally clear
- □ Rarely clear
- □ Never clear

31. Q7.4. Have you noticed any changes in water quality over time?

- □ Improved
- □ Remained the same
- □ Degraded

32. Q7.5. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much water quality affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Quantity

33. Q8.1. Is the amount of water available sufficient for your household's daily needs (for example, drinking, cooking and cleaning)?

- □ Always sufficient
- □ Mostly sufficient
- □ Occasionally sufficient
- □ Rarely sufficient
- □ Never sufficient

34. Q8.2. Approximately how much water does your household receive from its public or utility-managed network in a typical week?

- □ Approximate weekly volume: _____
- □ Unit: Liters / US gallons
- □ Do not know
- □ Not applicable: no relevant network service

35. Q8.3. Does your household face water shortages during peak use periods (for example, mornings)?

- □ Never
- □ Rarely
- □ Occasionally
- □ Frequently
- □ Always

36. Q8.4. Does the amount of water available to your household vary by season?

- □ No
- □ Minor variations
- □ Significant variations

37. Q8.6. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much water quantity affects your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Customer service

38. Q9.1. How would you rate the customer service provided by your water supplier, if applicable?

- □ Excellent
- □ Good
- □ Neutral
- □ Poor
- □ Very poor
- □ We have a full water system in-house (not dependent on any provider)

39. Q9.2. If your household reports problems to its water supplier, how promptly are they resolved?

- □ Always
- □ Most of the time
- □ Occasionally
- □ Rarely
- □ Never
- □ Not applicable: no relevant supplier or no complaints

40. Q9.4. Has your household experienced delays in obtaining water-supply services or repairs?

- □ Yes
- □ No
- □ Not aware

41. Q9.5. On a scale from 0 to 10, how much customer service and maintenance affect your overall water-service quality and experience?

- □ Rate from 0 to 10 (integer): _____

Household

42. Q15.10. How many people live in your household?

- □ 1
- □ 2
- □ 3
- □ 4
- □ 5
- □ 6
- □ 7
- □ 8 or more

43. Q15.14. How would you describe your dwelling?

- □ Individual house
- □ Apartment or flat
- □ Temporary housing
- □ Other dwelling type

Optional sensitivity questions

44. Q15.2. Which gender description best applies to you? (Optional)

- □ Female
- □ Male
- □ Another identity (optional self-description)
- □ Prefer not to answer

45. Q15.3. What is your age in completed years? (Optional)

- □ Age in completed years: _____
- □ Prefer not to answer

46. Q15.17. Approximately what is your household's annual income in your local currency? (Optional)

- □ Annual household income: _____
- □ Local currency: _____
- □ Do not know
- □ Prefer not to answer

Original question identifiers are retained. CORE-8 scores are the equal-weight average of applicable domain scores. Higher scores indicate better reported water service. International adaptations are not independently validated.